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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

SECOND SEMESTER MGU-UGP (HONOURS)/MGU-BBA (Honours)/MGU-BCA (Honours)/MGU-BVOC (Honours)
REGULAR/IMPROVEMENT/REAPPEARANCEEXAMINATIONS, APRIL 2026

Ability Enhancement Courses (AEC) - MG2AECENG101 - ENGLISH FOR ARTS AND HUMANITIES - PART II

Duration: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Maximum Marks: 50

Part A. MCQ. Answer all questions. Each question carries 1 mark

1. What is the silent letter in the word 'debt'? [U] / [CO1]
   Answer: c). B
2. Why is it important to repeat key ideas during a presentation? [U] / [CO2]
   Answer: c). To reinforce important points and make them easier to remember
3. Why do interviewers ask "Tell me about yourself"? [K] / [CO3]
   Answer: c). To assess the candidate's communication skills and relevant background
4. Which consonant sound is common to the words 'measure' and 'vision'?
   Answer: b). /ʒ/ [A] / [CO2]
5. He hung up the phone. The underlined means …….. [A] / [CO3]
   Answer: b). ended a call

[1x5 = 5]

Part B. SHORT ANSWER. Answer any 6 questions. Each question carries 5 marks

6. How do formal and informal greetings differ? Provide examples. [U] / [CO1]
   Answer: Formal greetings are polite, structured and used in professional or official contexts. They often include titles and respectful language, for example "Good morning, sir" or "How do you do?". Informal greetings are relaxed and used among friends or equals, for example "Hi", "What's up?" or "Hey there". The difference lies in tone, context and relationship.
7. Compare and contrast different types of debates. What are the unique characteristics of each? [U] / [CO2]
   Answer: Different debates vary in structure and purpose. Formal debates follow strict rules, roles and time limits, focusing on logical arguments. Panel debates involve multiple speakers sharing views with some flexibility. Group discussions are less structured and encourage participation from all. Extempore debates test spontaneity. Each differs in organisation, level of formality and interaction.
8. Prepare a cover letter in order to apply for the post of customer care officer in KPL Private Ltd. The applicant must have a degree in business management. [A] / [CO3]
   Answer: Give full credit to appropriate responses
9. What are the key elements of an effective apology? Provide examples. [U] / [CO1]
   Answer: An effective apology includes acknowledging the mistake, expressing regret, taking responsibility and offering to make amends. For example, "I am sorry for missing the deadline. I take full responsibility and will complete the task promptly." Sincerity and clarity are essential.
10. Explain the preparation needed for delivering a vote of thanks. [U] / [CO2]
    Answer: Preparation involves identifying key people to thank, organising points clearly and maintaining a polite tone. The speaker should mention organisers, participants and audience, keep it concise and deliver confidently. Clarity and appreciation are essential.
11. Prepare answer to the following question asked in a telephonic interview for the post of a reporter in a newspaper. (Use STAR method) "What do you consider your biggest professional achievement so far?" [U] / [CO3]
    Answer: Situation: During my internship, I covered a local community issue.
    Task: I had to gather accurate information and present it clearly.

Action: I interviewed residents, verified facts and wrote a balanced report.
Result: The article was published and appreciated for its clarity and impact. This remains my biggest professional achievement.

12. Explain how distance-based directions help someone understand routes better. [U] / [CO1]
    Answer: Distance based directions specify how far or how long to travel, such as “walk for five minutes” or “go 100 metres”. This helps the listener estimate time and progress, making navigation clearer and reducing confusion.
13. Briefly explain the key questions that can guide someone who is listening to a lecture. [U] / [CO2]
    Answer: Listeners can ask: What is the main idea? What are the key points? What examples support them? What is the purpose of the lecture? These questions improve comprehension and help retain important information.
14. Create a conversation where an employee calls their supervisor to request emergency leave due to a personal situation. The supervisor should acknowledge the request and discuss necessary arrangements. [A] / [CO3]
    Answer: Give full credit to appropriate responses

[5x6 = 30]

Part C. ESSAY. Answer any 1 question. Each question carries 15 marks

15. Why is small talk essential in professional settings? Discuss its role in teamwork, networking, and workplace harmony, and write a six-exchange conversation at a formal gathering where small talk helps establish a connection. [U] / [CO1]
    Answer: Small talk is vital in professional settings as it builds rapport and eases communication. It supports teamwork by creating comfort and trust among colleagues. It aids networking by initiating connections. It promotes harmony by reducing tension and stress. It acts as a bridge, enabling interaction without complex or personal discussion.
    Note: The conversation may be evaluated out of 5 marks.
16. Your close friend is feeling nervous about speaking in front of an audience. S/he has been shortlisted for the Best Director award at an International Short Film Festival. Based on your knowledge of public speaking, write a motivational note to encourage and support your friend. [U] / [CO2]
    Answer: Nervousness is natural, but this moment reflects hard work and creativity -- Being shortlisted is a significant achievement and recognition of talent --The audience already values your work, so your voice matters -- Focus on the message, not the fear -- Use simple techniques: deep breathing, slow speech and eye contact -- Confidence develops through preparation and clear thinking -- Trust your knowledge and understanding of your own work -- View the audience as supportive -- Turn nervous energy into positive energy -- Speak authentic and express your passion clearly
    Letter: Give appropriate credit to proper format
17. What are the key qualities employers look for in a candidate during a job interview? Describe the essential qualities such as communication skills, problem-solving ability, teamwork, adaptability, professionalism, and technical skills. Provide examples of how these qualities are assessed in an interview. [U] / [CO3]
    Answer: Employers assess candidates through key personal and professional qualities. Communication reflects clarity and confidence in responses. Problem solving is judged through situational questions. Teamwork is evaluated via past group experiences. Adaptability shows readiness for change. Professionalism appears in behaviour and attitude. Technical skills are tested through tasks or questions. Qualities like reliability and leadership indicate overall suitability and effective contribution.

[15x1 = 15]